

NorthPeak — SEO Playbook

What's already built into the site, what to do in the first week, and the ongoing routine that compounds over time.

Already Done For You

These were built into every page — no action needed:

- Unique, length-optimized title tag and meta description on all 32 pages
- Canonical URLs on every page (prevents duplicate-content penalties)
- Open Graph and Twitter Card tags so shared links render properly
- JSON-LD structured data: **AccountingService** on the homepage, **Article** schema on all 25 guides, **FAQPage** on Contact, **Service** + offer catalog on Services, **CollectionPage** on the hub
- One H1 per page with a correct heading hierarchy beneath it
- XML sitemap covering all 31 public URLs, plus robots.txt pointing to it
- Internal linking: every article links to three related guides and back to the hub and contact page
- Outbound citations to IRS.gov and SBA.gov (authority signals)
- Mobile-responsive, accessible (skip links, focus states, reduced-motion support), and fast — no frameworks, no build step, ~20 KB of CSS
- A custom 404 page marked **noindex**

Week One Checklist

1. Google Search Console

- 1Go to search.google.com/search-console and add **northpeakfp.com** as a Domain property.
- 2Verify via DNS TXT record (your host or registrar has a place to paste it).
- 3Under **Sitemaps**, submit: **sitemap.xml**
- 4Use **URL Inspection** on the homepage and click **Request Indexing** to speed up first crawl.

2. Google Business Profile — highest ROI item on this list

For a local accounting practice this typically drives more qualified enquiries than everything else combined. You now have everything needed: **(847) 644-2288** and **Wilmette, IL**. Use these details identically everywhere online — Google matches on exact consistency.

- 1Create the profile at google.com/business.
- 2Category: **Accountant** (add **Bookkeeping service** and **Tax preparation service** as secondary).
- 3If he works from home, choose **service-area business** — the address stays private but he still ranks locally.
- 4Add hours, services, and the website link. Post the articles to the profile's Updates feed.

5Ask the first 5 clients for Google reviews. Review count and recency are among the strongest local ranking factors.

3. Bing Webmaster Tools

Takes two minutes and imports directly from Search Console. Bing powers a meaningful slice of search and now feeds some AI assistants.

4. Analytics

Add Google Analytics 4 (or a lighter, privacy-friendly option like Plausible or Fathom). Paste the tracking snippet just before the closing `</body>` tag in each HTML file, or use your host's script-injection feature to add it site-wide at once.

The Ongoing Routine

Frequency	Action	Why it matters
Weekly	Publish or refresh one article	Consistent publishing is the single biggest ranking driver for a new site
Weekly	Post an article link to Google Business Profile	Activity signal + a free traffic channel
Monthly	Check Search Console for queries you rank for	Tells you what to write next — real demand, not guesses
Monthly	Fix any crawl errors or broken links reported	Small issues compound if ignored
Quarterly	Update the oldest articles with current figures	Freshness signal; tax numbers change annually
Ongoing	Request a review after every good client outcome	Reviews drive local rankings and conversion together

Backlinks — the honest version

A backlink is another website linking to yours. Google treats them as votes of confidence, so they genuinely move rankings. Two things matter:

Never buy them. Link-selling services ('500 backlinks for \$20') can get a site penalized or removed from Google entirely. For a financial services firm, that risk is not worth taking.

Legitimate ways to earn them, roughly in order of effort:

- Local chamber of commerce membership (usually includes a member directory link)
- Professional association directories and any state or trade body listings
- Reciprocal referral partners — a business attorney, a financial advisor, an insurance broker. Each of you links to the other's site as a trusted referral.
- Local business directories: Yelp, Bing Places, Apple Business Connect, industry-specific listings
- Guest articles for a local business publication or a partner's blog
- Being genuinely useful — the 25 guides exist partly so other sites have something worth linking to

Getting Found by AI Assistants

A growing share of people now ask ChatGPT, Claude, or Perplexity for recommendations instead of searching. The same structured data that helps Google helps here — it's already in place. Three things additionally help:

- Clear, direct answers near the top of each article (the guides are already written this way)

- FAQ schema — already on the Contact page; consider adding FAQs to individual service pages
- Consistent business details (name, address, phone) everywhere they appear online. Inconsistency confuses both local search and AI retrieval.

What to Measure

Ignore vanity metrics. For a firm this size, four numbers matter:

Metric	Where	Target trend
Consultation bookings	Calendar / form inbox	The only number that pays the bills
Impressions in Search Console	Search Console	Should climb steadily from month 2 onward
Google Business Profile calls/clicks	Business Profile dashboard	Usually the first channel to convert
Which articles get traffic	Search Console → Pages	Tells you what to write more of

Realistic expectation: a brand-new site typically sees little organic traffic for the first 8–12 weeks, then compounds. The Google Business Profile will produce results much sooner. Don't judge the SEO work before the three-month mark.